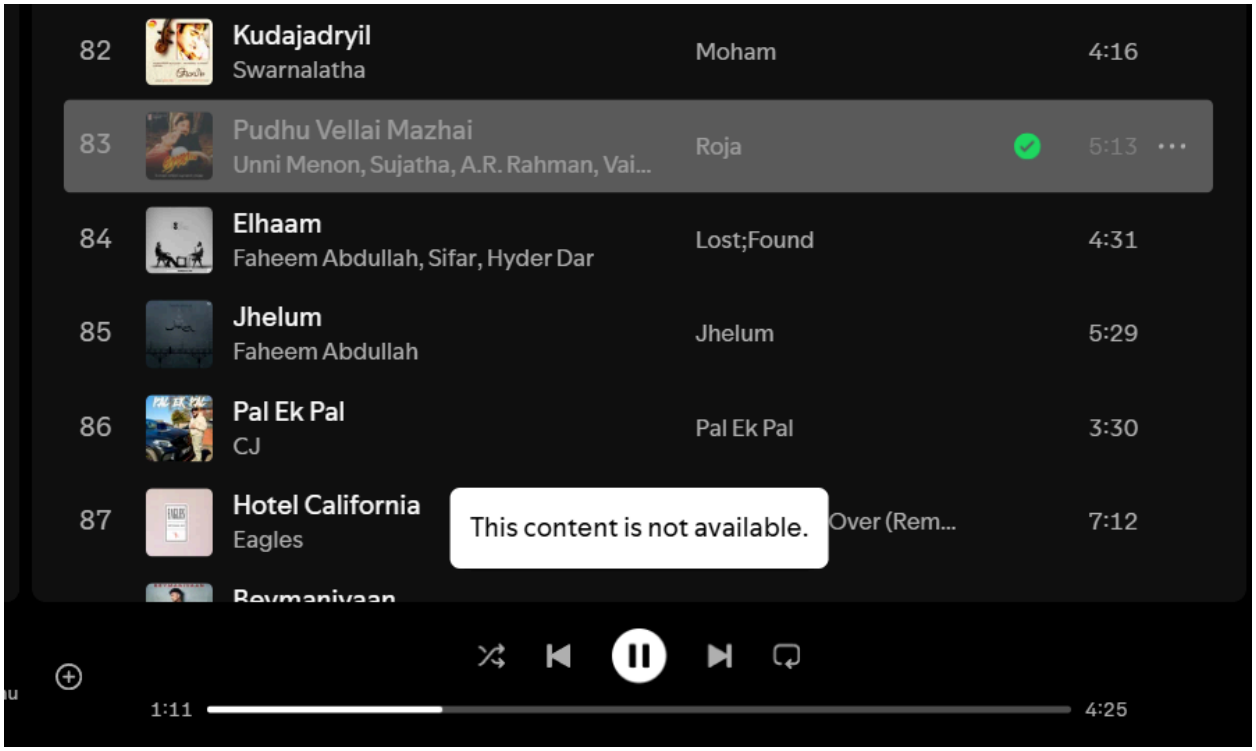
Application / Website / Technology Name: Spotify Desktop (Free)

Application / Website Description: A desktop music-streaming application that allows users to search, discover and listen to music.

Heuristic: Help users recognize, diagnose and recover from errors

Severity: 2

Screenshot:



Explanation of problem and justification of severity rating:

When someone tries to play a track that isn't available, Spotify just throws up a generic "This content is not available" message. The problem is, it leaves users in the dark—it doesn't explain whether the song was pulled, region-locked, or down due to a glitch, nor does it offer any obvious next steps. For a new user, this can be pretty confusing. I gave this a severity rating of 2 because while it causes a bit of friction and confusion, it doesn't completely block people from listening to other songs.

A way to solve this problem:
Spotify could make error messages much clearer by spelling out exactly why a track can't be played. To help users move on, it could also point them toward an alternate version or offer a quick way to jump back to their previous page.

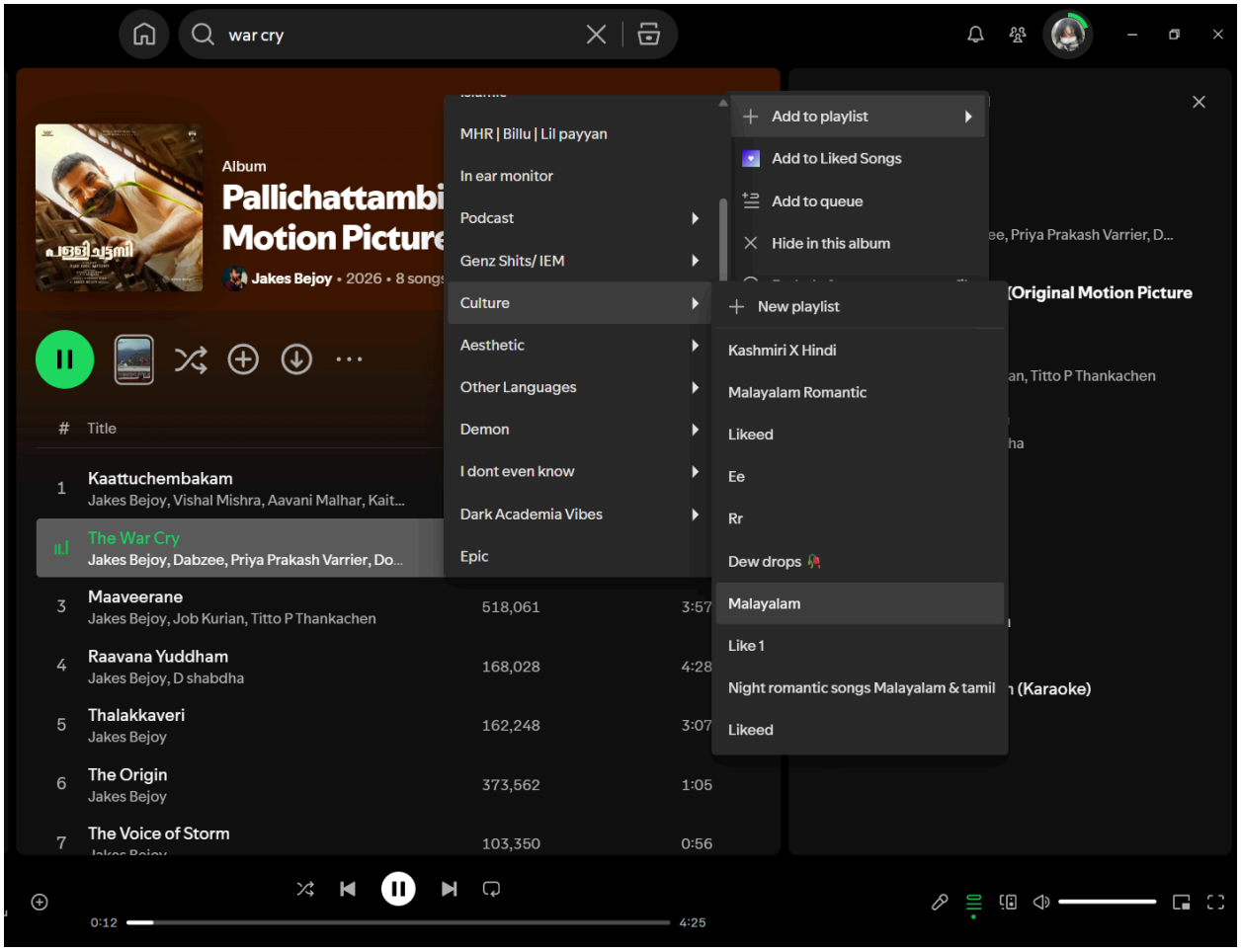
Application / Website / Technology Name: Spotify Desktop (Free)

Application / Website Description: A desktop music-streaming application that allows users to search, discover and listen to music.

Heuristic: Recognition rather than recall

Severity: 2

Screenshot:



Explanation of problem and justification of severity rating:

When trying to add a track to a playlist, Spotify opens a cascade of playlist folders and sub-menus. If you've built up a lot of playlists over time, tracking down the right one turns into a tedious hunt—especially when they're tucked away inside nested folders. Instead of instantly seeing where to put a song, you have to mentally map out where you saved everything. I rated this a 2 because while it definitely slows down a routine task and creates unnecessary friction, it doesn't actually stop you from adding the track.

A way to solve this problem:
Spotify could streamline this by adding a quick search bar right inside the playlist picker and pinning your most frequently used playlists near the top. That way, adding songs stays quick and effortless, no matter how large your library gets.

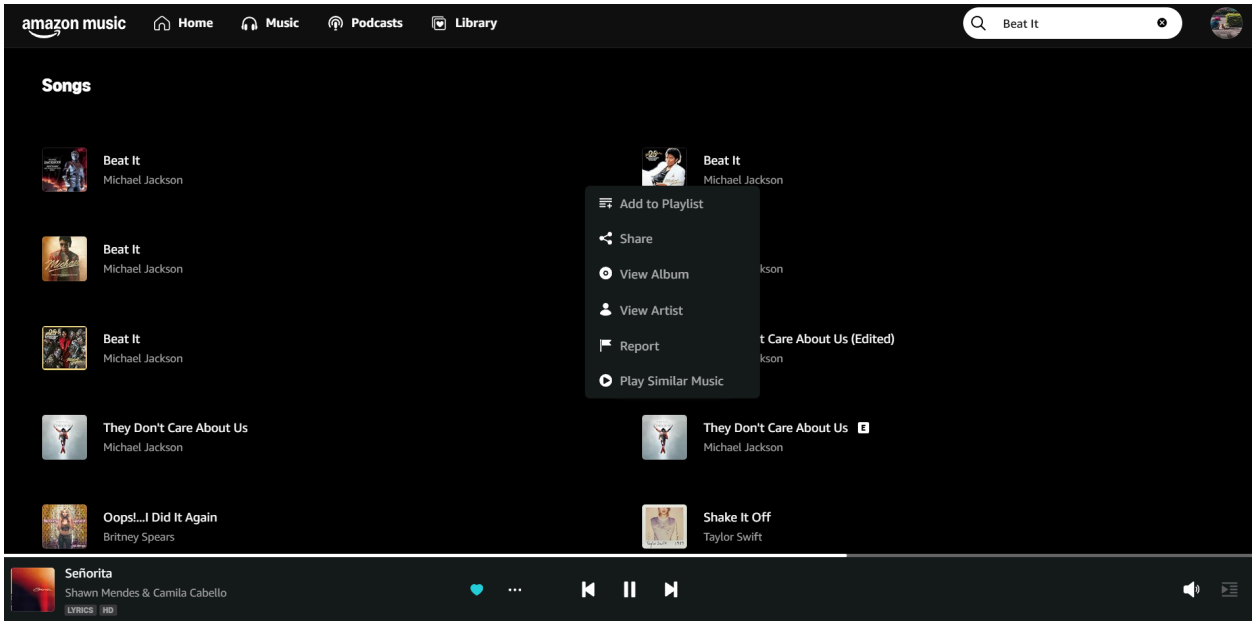
Application / Website / Technology Name: Amazon Music Web

Application / Website Description: Amazon Music is a music-streaming service that allows users to search for songs, albums, artists and playlists.

Heuristic: Match between system and the real world

Severity: 2

Screenshot:



Explanation of problem and justification of severity rating:

When users search for a song like "Beat It", Amazon Music displays multiple results with the same song title and artist but different album artwork. However, the album names are not clearly displayed alongside the results. This makes it difficult for users to understand why there are multiple versions and identify the one they are looking for. I rated this a 2 because it creates confusion during song selection, but users can still choose a track by checking its artwork.

A way to solve this problem:

Amazon Music could display the album name and version information more clearly below each song result. This would help users understand the differences between similar results and choose the correct version without having to open each album individually.

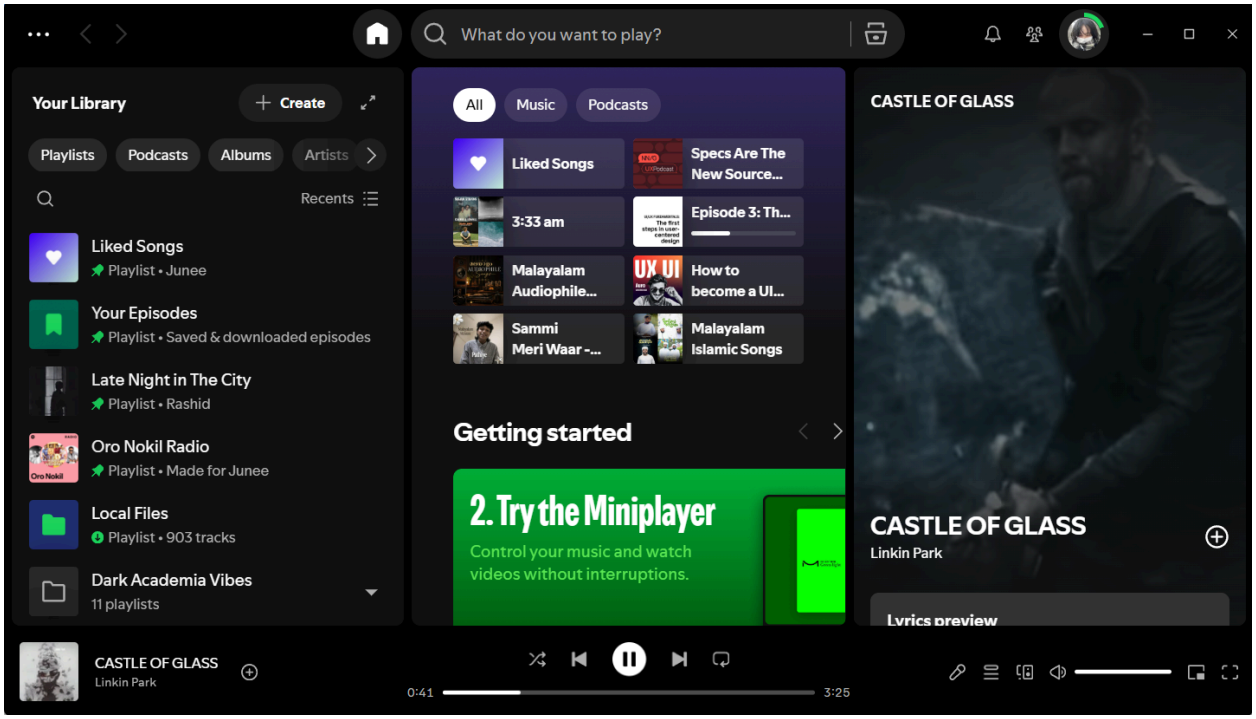
Application / Website / Technology Name: Spotify Desktop (Free)

Application / Website Description: A desktop music-streaming application that allows users to search, discover and listen to music.

Heuristic: Aesthetic and minimalist design

Severity: 2

Screenshot:



Explanation of problem and justification of severity rating:
The Spotify home screen feels pretty cluttered right now because it throws a lot at you all at once—playlists, recommendations, podcasts, promotions, and your library. On top of that, the Now Playing panel on the right side eats up a chunk of the screen. Having so many things fighting for your attention makes it kind of frustrating to just focus on what you actually want to listen to. I'd rate this a 2 since it definitely hurts the overall flow and comfort, even though you can still get where you need to go.

A way to solve this problem:
A simple fix would be sharpening the visual layout so the things people actually use stand out more, rather than overwhelming them with competing content. Giving users an easy way to hide or collapse side panels they aren't using would also go a long way.

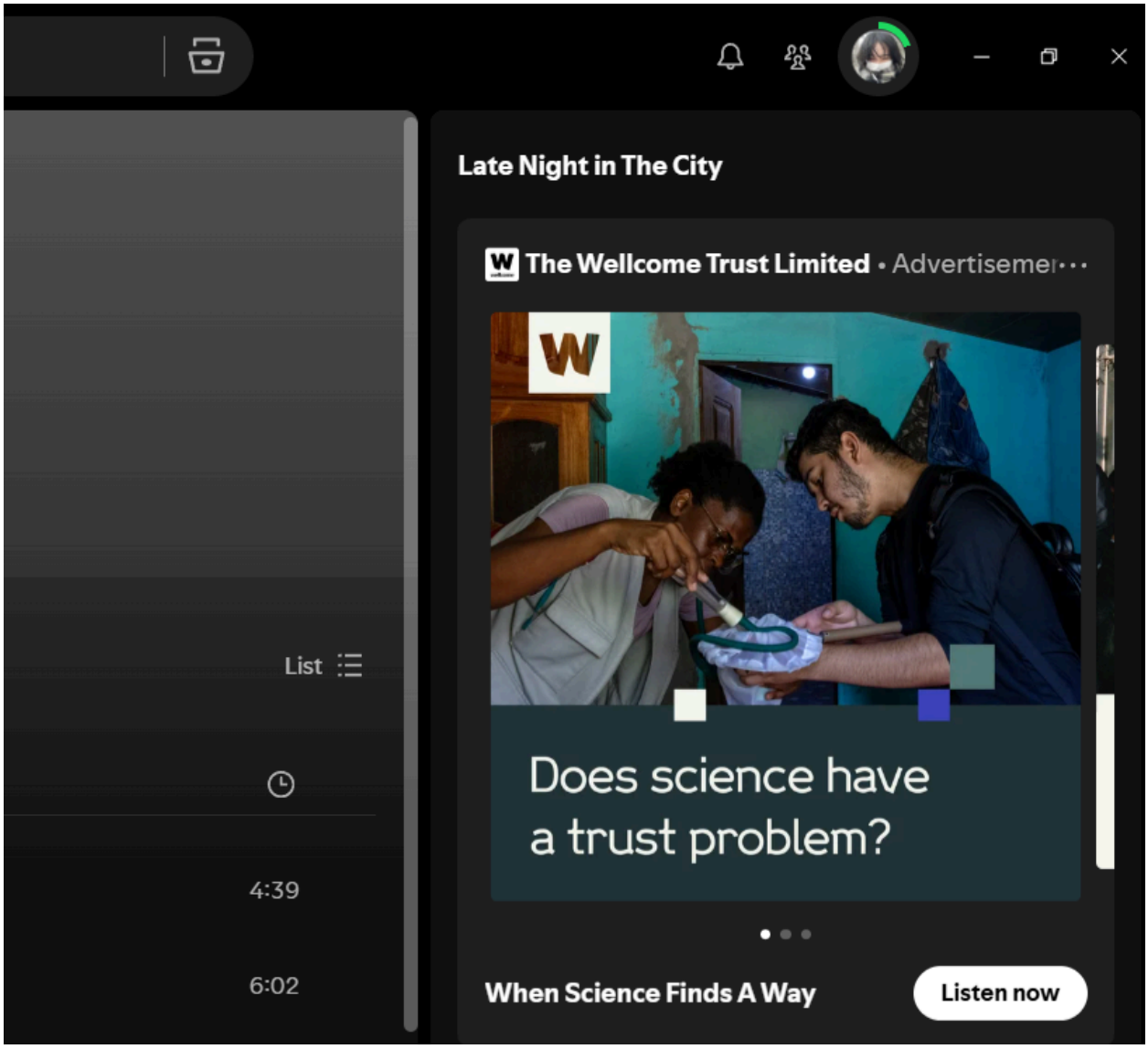
Application / Website / Technology Name: Spotify Desktop (Free)

Application / Website Description: A desktop music-streaming application that allows users to search, discover and listen to music.

Heuristic: Visibility of system status

Severity: 2

Screenshot:



Explanation of problem and justification of severity rating:

While an ad plays, Spotify shows the message "Your music will continue after the break," but the ad container simultaneously displays a loading spinner. It's hard to tell whether the ad is still buffering or if audio playback has paused, leaving users guessing about the app's actual status. I assigned a severity rating of 2 since it causes mild confusion without completely blocking the user experience.

A way to solve this problem:
Spotify could clarify this by explicitly stating whether the ad is currently buffering or playing, giving users immediate feedback on what's happening behind the scenes.